Client Onboarding SOP

Owner: Client Services Lead. Version 3.2. Applies to every new client account.

1 Purpose

This procedure makes sure every new client gets the same structured start: a signed agreement, a named account manager, working access to the client portal and a kickoff call within five business days of signing.

2 Scope

It applies to all new retainer and project clients. One-off consultations under 4 hours do not need the full onboarding and only need steps 1 and 2 of section 3.

3 Procedure

3.1 Before the kickoff call

1. Confirm the signed service agreement is saved in the client folder on the shared drive under Clients > Client Name > Contracts.
2. Create the client record in the CRM and set the status to Onboarding.
3. Assign an account manager. Retainers above 20 hours a month get a senior account manager.
4. Send the Welcome Pack email using template CS-01 within one business day of signing.
5. Create the client portal account and send the invitation from the portal, not from personal email.
6. Book the kickoff call for a date within five business days of signing.

3.2 Kickoff call

1. Use the Kickoff Agenda template CS-02 and share it with the client 24 hours before the call.
2. Confirm the main contact, the billing contact and the escalation contact.
3. Agree the reporting schedule: weekly for project clients, monthly for retainer clients.
4. Walk the client through the portal: raising requests, viewing reports and downloading invoices.
5. Record the call notes in the CRM within the same business day.

3.3 After the kickoff call

1. Send the kickoff summary email using template CS-03 within one business day.
2. Set up the recurring report in the reporting tool.
3. Change the CRM status from Onboarding to Active once the first report is scheduled.
4. Schedule a 30-day check-in call with the client.

4 Templates

CS-01 Welcome Pack email. CS-02 Kickoff Agenda. CS-03 Kickoff Summary email. All templates are in the shared drive under Templates > Client Services.

5 Quality checks

The Client Services Lead reviews every new account at day 30. An onboarding is complete when the client has logged into the portal, received a first report and attended the 30-day check-in.